

PMP4

Coursera

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Meet the Team

Aakash Ahuja

Role: Product Manager

Responsibility: In charge of ideating and mapping out the vision of the product features as well as delegating the roles and responsibilities of each team member.

Chae Woon Kim

Role: Head Research Analyst

Responsibility: In charge of the secondary research and mapping out the competitive analysis as well as the rationale behind the product choice.

Cristian Puente-Ortiz

Role: Head UX/UI Designer

Responsibility: In charge of the wireframes and the overall design and logistics of the features, as well as the User Stories and Personas.

Team Responsibilities: Product vision statement, long-term improvements for future products as well as primary research.

Company Assessment and Context

ABOUT COURSERA AND MASSIVE ONLINE OPEN COURSES (MOOCs):

Coursera is an online learning platform founded in 2012 that offers people belonging to different backgrounds (be it students, professionals, or novices) access to massive amounts of open online courses to help them transform their lives by learning new skills.

Once thought of as the big disruptor to traditional higher education, the anticipation of Massive Open Online Courses was thought to galvanize the education sphere since the inception of companies such as Coursera, edX, and Udacity. However, with few participants rarely completing the courses, MOOCs have come under scrutiny on whether they are the saviors to the antiquated ways of education [2].



Company Vision:

Coursera has a vision of providing life-transforming learning experiences to anyone, anywhere [21].

Current Product Portfolio & History:

Coursera provides learning resources at extremely reduced prices for:

1. Students of Universities- Coursera for Universities
2. Employees of an organisation- Coursera for Business
3. Government employees- Coursera for Government
4. Coursera for Everyone

Their product portfolio includes [4, 21]:

- Courses
- Guided Projects
- Specializations
- Professional Certifications
- Master's Track & degrees
- Signature Track

Out of their product offerings, Coursera's most significant contributor has been the Signature Track where students who wish to earn a certificate of completion can opt to pay per course fee to participate. Launched in 2013, the Signature Track has become Coursera's first successful attempt to monetize its platform with more than \$1 million in revenue in less than a year of its inception back in 2013. The success of this feature has spurred other products such as Specializations [4, 22]. With students able to show their certificates to employers to prove their professional qualifications, the Signature Track has been the first of its kind on MOOC platforms that link the user's coursework to their real identity. With the ability to easily link the user's biometric profile as well as the relatively low barrier to entry with affordable costs to sign up for a Signature Track, students are able to validate their learning experience into transferable credit [22].

Research Plan

How did we tackle our research?

For our proposal, we've devised a Research Plan that focuses on the process of how we formulated our feature set through the research we've gathered. For our product vision, we decided to focus on the Signature Track, to better scope and hone in on Coursera.

To start, we conducted secondary research to gain a deeper understanding of Coursera and the problems that currently surround it; this is how we framed our secondary research:

- Identify the current industry and competitive landscape through secondary research (existing articles, industry profiles, and reports).
- Utilize Coursera to identify the issues that we as the users face in terms of user experience as well as noting potential routes of improvements with current features.
- Whilst conducting secondary research we've also formulated potential research questions as well as jotting down missing key information such as user insights and user behavior.

After conducting our secondary research we were able to identify the pattern and the trends of both the user base of Coursera as well as the breakdown of the competitive landscape. From then on, we wanted to further probe into user behaviours and how we could possibly map out our features by complementing the demands of the existing users:

- We conducted surveys to find insight into specific problems the current MOOC and Coursera users are encountering (engagement, retention, and career-related issues) as well as finding routes where we could reinforce our argument, as well as help, validate our features.
- Questions that were asked in the survey [Appendix 1.1]:
 - When you use e-learning platforms what do you expect to gain out of it (career-related, educational skill set, etc.)?
 - What are the biggest challenges that you face when taking an online course through an e-learning platform?
 - On a scale of 1-10, how much do you prioritize the material you learn from e-learning platforms?
 - What can e-learning platforms do better to keep individuals motivated to complete the course?

Post Research:

Once we gathered all the necessary research from our primary and secondary data, we started to craft our argument and feature set:

- We mapped out features based on the research that was conducted as well as establish a product vision that aligns with the company vision
- Articulated how the features will benefit and add value to the target user, in addition to how it will be measured.
- Formulated a user story, persona, and target user based on the research that was gathered and created the archetype that characterizes the research we've scrutinized.
- Created a launch strategy plan to map out how the features would theoretically roll out and tie in a long term vision on how we saw the features would be launched and iterated.

Competitive Analysis

Competitive Landscape:

Coursera is classified as a Massive Open Online Courses directory where users are able to access or purchase courses from established vendors such as universities. In recent years, Coursera has become the mainstay in the MOOC for providing courses with both academic and professional validity [2, 7, 8, 20].

We've identified three key competitors that resemble both a similar and different archetype to Coursera to better illustrate where Coursera lies in the competitive landscape:

- edX: An e-learning platform that is a direct competitor to Coursera. Like Coursera, edX's product offerings range from free courses to cheaper college credits, which can work towards a full degree. Currently, edX has partnerships with over 120 institutions and has garnered over 20 million students. What differentiates edX from other competitors and MOOCs is that students are able to audit classes for free even if they're part of a larger certificate program, thus allowing students to consider whether they want to fully commit to a program and see how the program is laid out before committing [13, 14, 15].
- LinkedIn Learning: Tied together with LinkedIn's main platform, LinkedIn Learning is a bite-sized learning portal that caters to a wide range of audiences, which allows users to access a catalogue of video courses offered through the LinkedIn platform where users are taught by industry professionals. This initiative came shortly after LinkedIn's



acquisition of Lynda.com in 2015, which a large portion of its content is based on. Currently, there are upwards of 15,000+ courses ranging from programming, accounting, and other career-related subjects. LinkedIn's initiative of providing an education outlet tied to their mission of providing a hub for users to leverage the existing platform, whilst building up their skill tree through profiles they've built up on LinkedIn. Unlike the other MOOC offerings, LinkedIn Learning has adopted a subscription model where users are charged on a monthly basis [18, 19, 23].

- Udacity: A more niche platform compared to its competitors, Udacity is unknown for its content that is taught by qualified professionals in niche fields. Whilst its competitors are aiming for a more ubiquitous approach with its offerings, Udacity is tailored to a more skills-based platform for professionals where the programs and credentials are industry-specific. Its signature nanodegree programs provide perks such as review, feedback, and even personal coaching sessions, Udacity will go as far as offering a tuition reimbursement and a job guarantee as part of some of their nano degree offerings [15, 16, 17].

As illustrated by its main competitors, Coursera's offerings and value, similar to edX lie in its partnerships with education institutions worldwide, where students are able to be taught by qualified instructors to better prepare them both academically and professionally.

Rationale and Research Findings

BUT, WHY COURSERA?

In an age where job insecurity & unemployment has become tumultuous (Higher unemployment rate in 2020 than the Great Recession), we believe that Coursera's vision of providing life-transforming learning experiences can have a strong influence on individuals like ourselves. As users of Coursera, we believe that there are certain pain points that need to be addressed in order to improve both the overall experience and the impact that Coursera can have on its users. Through primary and secondary research, we've devised multiple feature recommendations to pain points we've outlined in the coming sections of the report [1].

CURRENT SITUATION

As of 2019, there are roughly 120 million people from around the world enrolled in MOOCs, with 40% of the participants enrolled with Coursera [3]. Known for its availability and key strategic partnerships with well-known institutions, Coursera has grown from 26 million users in 2017 to



roughly 45 million users as of 2019, with 83% of Coursera users having at least a Bachelor's degree and 70% of which have been participating in the Signature Track [22]. Coursera's product prices ranging from free auditing courses to \$30,000-degree programs, Coursera's diverse course offerings have made it the most popular distributor of MOOCs worldwide [4, 5, 7].

Yet despite these encouraging signs, in an article from the Harvard Business Review, where a survey was sent to 780,000 people from 212 countries, all of whom had completed a Coursera course, roughly 4% of Coursera users who have watched at least one-course lecture went on to complete the course and receive a credential [5]. Whilst that may not seem like a problem to Coursera, in a study conducted by MIT and Harvard revealed that 95% of students dropped their online courses even before completion [6]. Assuming many of those dropped before the 14-day refund period, that means that there is less revenue created for Coursera.

From the research we've outlined, we asked ourselves the question of why Coursera and Massive Open Online Courses were facing these issues.

What is the primary goal of doing online courses for this population? Does a demand for credible online learning exist?

According to the same survey that was conducted in the Harvard Business Review by Data Scientists from Coursera as well as the Vice Provost of Global Initiatives at the University of Pennsylvania, the survey illustrates that career-related benefits have been a large reason as to why people take courses through Coursera. Roughly 52% of the people who surveyed reported the primary goal of completing a course through Coursera was due to career-related goals such as improving their current job or finding a new job [5, 7].

Are the skills gained through online education valued in the job market?

It was crucial to test our assumptions about the credibility of online courses when compared to in-person courses in the job market.

According to another article from the Harvard Business Review, in a national survey, 61% of hiring leaders saw credentials earned online as equal to if not better than those completed in person [8].

In another survey conducted by the Harvard Business Review, 64% of employers agreed that the need for continuous lifelong learning will demand higher levels of education and more credentials [8].

From the findings mentioned previously, we've devised that in a dynamic job environment, to maintain your employability, the need to constantly upskill will remain & and be a crucial part



of one's career path. With the high tuition rate that might deter in-person learning, online learning can definitely fill in that void.

To further elaborate upon the previous point, MOOC users believe that online courses have helped them significantly in their careers. Roughly 87% of the MOOC users surveyed by HBR reported a benefit of some kind towards their goal- be it getting a raise, finding a new job, or starting their own business [6].

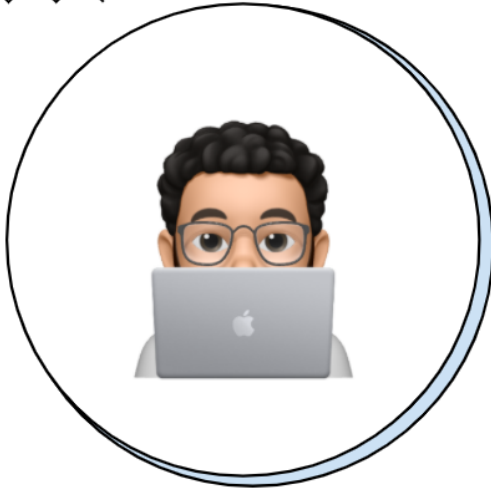
If such tangible benefits exist, why don't people who enroll in these courses end up completing them?

With our secondary research, we've identified that the primary goal of their target users is to make advances in their careers. Furthermore, we've found that the majority of people who complete the courses on Coursera do end up experiencing some tangible career benefit. However, if users do not end up completing the courses, not only will they be unable to obtain the value they sought after, but they question the platform's credibility in order to help achieve their user's goals.

In order to gain insight into why people don't complete the courses they've enrolled in, we've conducted a survey where we asked our target audience on why and what can be done to mitigate or possibly alleviate this issue. This way we were not only able to better articulate the pain points and intentions of our target users but to help us better formulate and give a more accurate representation of our personas, user stories, and features [Appendix 1.1].

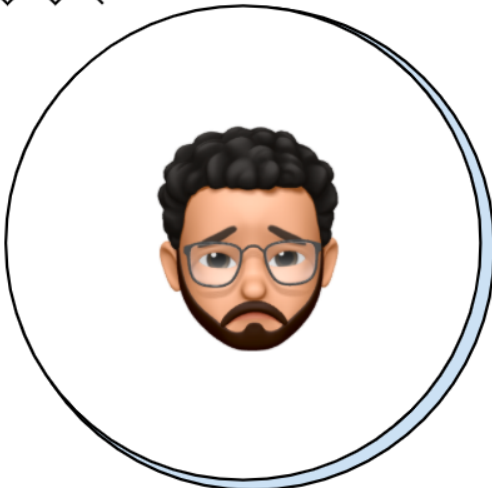
Personas

Here is our Persona, Dave who is an amalgamation of our secondary research & primary research that we conducted with more than 25 people belonging to our target audience (**People pursuing or having completed bachelor's degree**)



Meet Dave.

- Bachelor's Degree in Data Science
- Seeking a Full Time Job
- Wants to Expand his Current Skill Set
- Goes to Coursera & finds a course that aligns with his career goals



Meet Dave.

- Motivated to learn new skills
- External factors catch up & shifts his focus elsewhere
- Year later, still hasn't finished the course & wonders why he signed up in the first place



Research Insights

From our primary & secondary research, we've boiled the pain points of our target audience down into these insights (all quotes are from the responses in the Survey):

The biggest challenges that remain for MOOCS are [Appendix 1] :

- **Motivation:** Keeping the motivation high among learners to complete their courses

"Staying focused on course"

"Motivation-- sometimes need more internal drive to accomplish the online courses"

- **Discipline & Accountability in Learning:** Taking time out of your day to complete courses regularly

"Being accountable about my learning"

- **No end goal in sight:** People fail to keep in sight how doing these courses will help them in the long run.

"Motivation & enough "consequences" to push through to the end of the course"

And the biggest gains that people expect out of courses are:

- **Career Related:** To get hired or increase employability by upskilling themselves.

"Usually I use it to gain skills that are either not taught in school, or needed for my job. The goal is to apply these skills in a professional setting."

"Mostly skillset, especially ones that are not taught in school"

Lastly, when asked about what MOOCs can do to keep participants motivated:

- Users spoke of ways to incentivize or gamify the system to keep students motivated and increase accountability, such as ways of setting rewards.

"Structure and deadlines to incentivize the student to complete it."

We've outlined some user quotes about problems that users faced while doing courses on Coursera:

"I end up starting a lot of courses, but not completing them. There is no self motivation"

"The courses sometimes are too long. I wish coursera had better mini-courses."



“ The time investment is too much for me. Sometimes, i doubt if the course will help me in the long run ”

Product Vision Statement

From the research we've gathered we challenged ourselves to device a feature set that could alleviate the pain points that were mentioned above:

Aligned with the vision statement of providing life-transforming learning experiences to anyone, we've decided to focus our attention on: **Providing actionable and transferable learning experiences through the proposed features to students that are currently pursuing a Bachelor's or higher level of education through Coursera's Signature Track, to increase retention and improve employability through the Coursera platform.**

Features and Recommendations

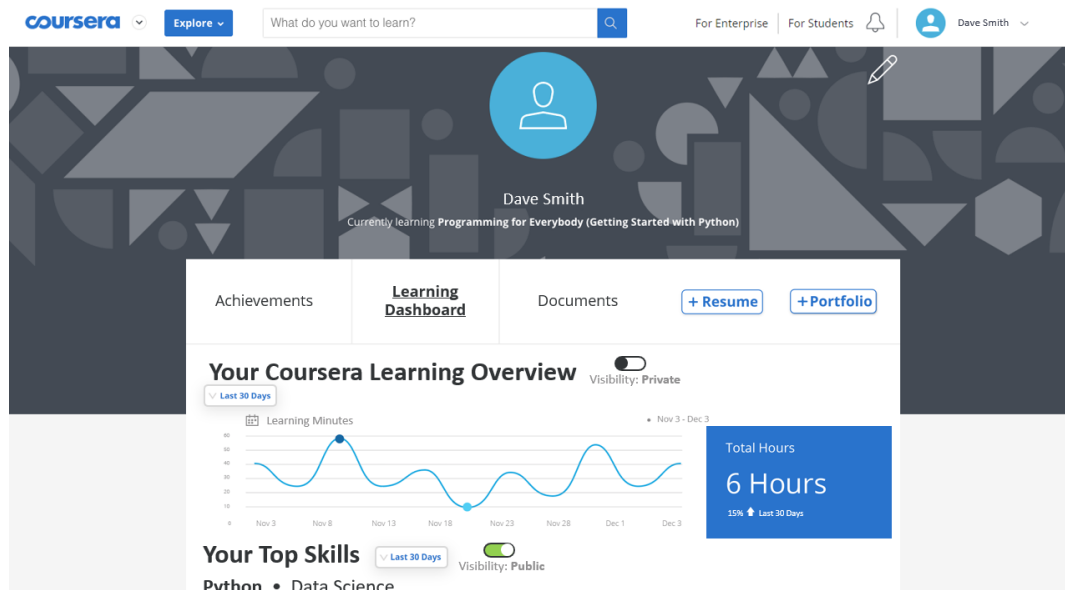
Learning Dashboard

1. Description of Feature: It provides users an overview of metrics and data about the courses they are taking. It shows them how far in their learning they have come, how much time they have invested, and encourages them to continue learning.

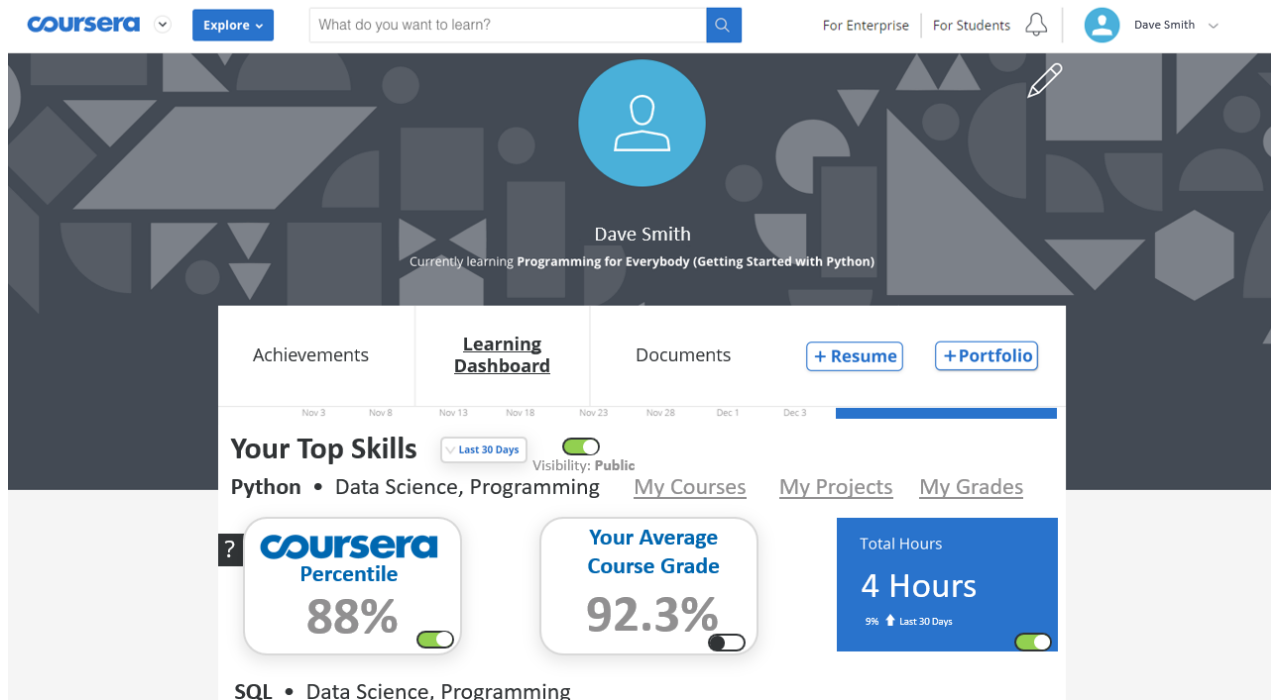
Further down on the Learning Dashboard, the Top Skills section groups together metrics related to marketable, career-building skills the user is developing based on their courses. So, users are able to see, tangibly and quantifiably, what skills they have been working on and are motivated to continue honing in on certain skills and courses.

The all-new Coursera Percentile metric: gamifies learning on these important skills. Based on a benchmark with other Coursera users, the many Coursera students seeking career-related goals are able to distinguish their applications.

2. Benefits: Competitive & certifiable metrics about users' learnings and progress on courses. Clear skills being developed are articulated to users. Quantifiable metrics motivate users to reflect on the effort they have put into courses.



Learning Overview



Top Skills Section, with Coursera Percentile

Shareable User Profile

1. Description of Feature: Currently, Coursera has a user profile page with only a list of 'Achievements', which is a list of completed courses. The Learning Dashboard & career-related Documents features would expand upon this to create a deeper user profile. The User Profile would also be shareable via a link that users can share. Coursera users would gain a robust and customizable user profile that they can use to demonstrate and articulate the skills learned from their completed courses.

Part of that is allowing users to customize the metrics in their learning dashboard as public or private. They would be able to choose which metrics, if any, would be visible on their public profile by using privacy toggles. They can also toggle entire sections as public or private to make it easier for users to control their privacy. Profiles would also only be found via the unique URL that users share (or choose not to share), and users would be notified before the feature rolls out.

2. Benefits: This feature means users can easily share their public profile with recruiters. Everything achieved on Coursera can be added to this profile, which creates a clear end goal and immediate benefit for each course or project. From our research, we found that many students lose motivation from a lack of immediate benefits.

The screenshot shows the Coursera user profile for Dave Smith. The profile is currently set to "Public" visibility. A blue arrow points to the "Visibility: Public" toggle, with a callout box stating: "Toggle allows users to customize what appears on their public profile. They can hide by section or metric." The dashboard includes sections for "Your Top Skills" (Python, Data Science, Programming), "Your Average Course Grade" (92.3%), and "Total Hours" (4 Hours). The "Coursera Percentile" is 88%. The "Learning Dashboard" is active, and the "Documents" section shows a "+ Resume" and "+ Portfolio" button. The "My Courses" section shows "SQL • Data Science Programming".

Shareable User Profile: Privacy Toggles

The screenshot shows the same Coursera user profile for Dave Smith, but with the "Visibility" toggle set to "Private". A blue arrow points to the "Visibility: Private" toggle, with a callout box stating: "Toggle allows users to customize what appears on their public profile. They can hide by section or metric." The dashboard layout is identical to the previous screenshot, but the "Your Top Skills" section now shows "Python • Data Science, Programming" with a "Last 30 Days" filter. The "Coursera Percentile" is 88%, "Your Average Course Grade" is 92.3%, and "Total Hours" is 4 Hours. The "Learning Dashboard" is active, and the "Documents" section shows a "+ Resume" and "+ Portfolio" button. The "My Courses" section shows "SQL • Data Science Programming".

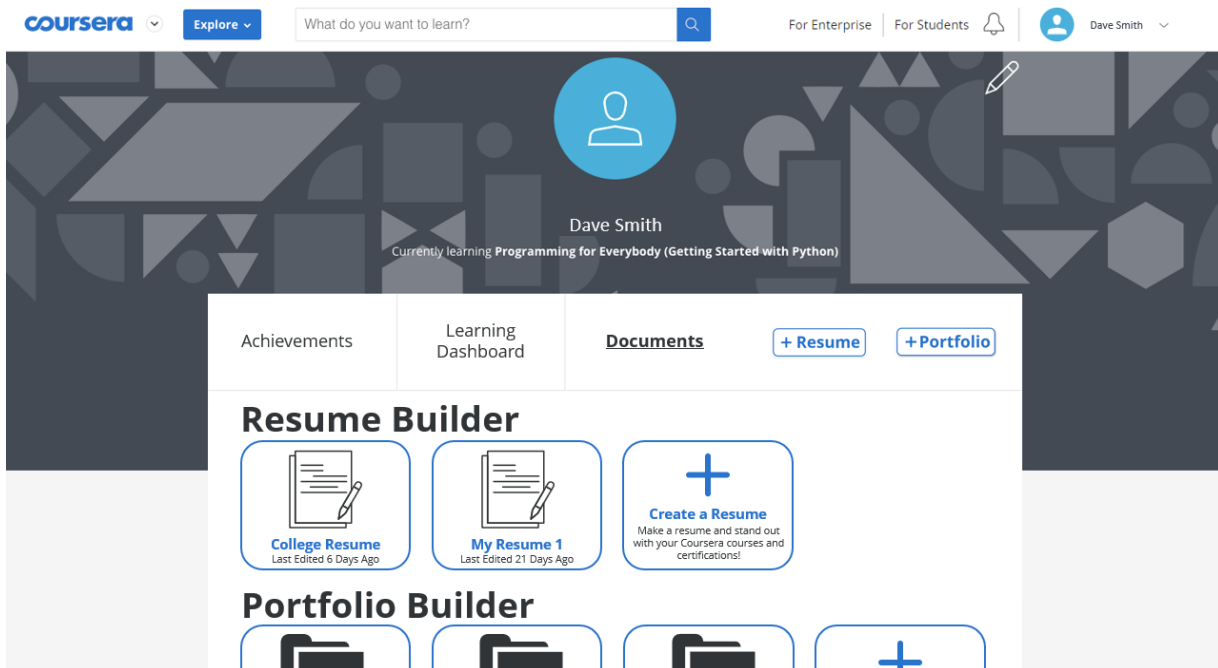
Shareable User Profile: Privacy Toggles (Private)

Documents: Resume & Portfolio

1. Description of Feature: As mentioned earlier, many Users use Coursera to help them achieve career-related goals. In order to effectively assist users in reaching what could be life-transforming career goals, it requires going beyond just taking a course and equipping users to *show* what they have learned. Of course, the traditional method for this, for showing achievements, is a resume, so the Resume Builder would offer the tools to do that. Coursera certifications would be integrated onto that so public resumes would have validated coursework and skills.

Even more tangibly, portfolios allow users to showcase their projects, and since many courses have assignments and projects users may want to share -- the Portfolio Builder allows users to add projects & assignments from their Coursera courses onto portfolios shareable with recruiters or anyone they want to impress.

2. Benefits: These document features provide Coursera users with the ability to set up a professional user profile, similar to what would be included on a personal website. However, Coursera would have certifiable content and would allow non-technical users to host that information without paying for the development of a website. The documents that are critical for career development, would help users articulate their experiences and promote the work they completed in their Coursera courses. It also reminds users about the immediate benefit and motivates high-quality work.



Documents Tab on User Profile

The screenshot displays the Coursera user interface for a user named Dave Smith. At the top, the Coursera logo is on the left, followed by an 'Explore' button and a search bar with the placeholder text 'What do you want to learn?'. To the right of the search bar are links for 'For Enterprise' and 'For Students', a notification bell icon, and a user profile icon labeled 'Dave Smith'. Below the header, a large dark banner features a circular profile picture placeholder and the text 'Dave Smith' and 'Currently learning Programming for Everybody (Getting Started with Python)'. A navigation bar below the banner contains tabs for 'Achievements', 'Learning Dashboard', and 'Documents', along with '+ Resume' and '+ Portfolio' buttons. The main content area is titled 'Your Project Assignments' and includes a sub-header 'Add past projects and assignments to your portfolio.' On the right of this section is a link to 'Portfolio: "Portfolio 1"' with a settings gear icon. Two project entries are listed: 'Structuring Machine Learning Projects' (Achieved Jul 27 2020) and 'Improving Deep Neural Networks: Hyperparameter tuning, Regularization and Optimization' (Achieved Jul 21 2020). Each project has a list of associated projects with a plus icon to add them to the portfolio. For 'Structuring Machine Learning Projects', the projects are 'Machine Learning Algorithm Project 1' and 'Machine Learning Algorithm Project 2'. For 'Improving Deep Neural Networks...', the projects are 'Basic Neural Network', 'Intermediate Neural Network', and 'Advanced Neural Network'.

Editing "Portfolio 1" using the Portfolio Builder

User Stories (Pain Point)

Based on the features we devised for Dave, here's Dave's take on them and how they will solve some of the problems he faces while using Coursera.

1. **Feature 1:** Learning Dashboard

Goal: Reinforcing & Encouraging Progress

Dave's Take: As a user, Dave feels that the learning dashboard is a great way to show him how far in his learning he's come, how much time he has invested in his learning, and encourages him to continue learning.

2. **Feature 2 & 3:** Shareable Profile & Add to Resume/Portfolio feature

Goal: Learning to market yourself using your skills & having an end goal for each course

Dave's take: As a user, Dave feels that using the Shareable Profile & Resume/Portfolio builder, he is able to market his skills & projects in a better way to achieve his career goals. He has more confidence in his skillset and is more eager to do courses to strengthen his skillset & add substance to his user profile. Sharing his public profile & learning dashboard with recruiters, he has more credibility regarding these new skills. This all provides Dave and his recruiters with one central access point that shows Dave's learning.

(This is something that we found from our research-no immediate benefit from a course/project on Coursera)

Product Management Canvas

Idea Product Vision: Providing actionable and transferable learning experiences through the proposed features to students that are currently pursuing a Bachelor's or higher level of education through Coursera, to increase retention and improve employability through the Coursera Platform. <u>Coursera User Profiles: Reimagined</u> Instead of only listing user "achievements", which are completed courses, users would gain a Learning Dashboard, career-related Documents, and the ability to share their User Profile with recruiters or anyone they want to impress. 	Market 70% of Coursera Users go through the Signature Track, Coursera's paid model for taking courses on the platform. These paid users, create a market of verified users that are enrolled in courses. This fits with the benefits of seeing learning metrics and helps with credibility for profile sharing.  Customer Segment 'Dave' is our Persona and an amalgamation of our secondary research & primary research that we conducted with more than 25 people belonging to our target audience. He's pursuing a Bachelor's degree, seeking a full-time job, and is using Coursera to expand his skills in order to meet career goals. 	Business Value By improving the quality of service, users are more likely to join the Signature Track to be able to showcase their learning in a certifiable way, beyond individual certificates. Not only can users now share links to each course they have completed on their resume, but instead, can share a URL that provides an all-encompassing view into their work and studies. Since most (53% [5, 7]) Coursera users are seeking career goals, ways to distinguish their applications and articulate their skills are incredibly valuable. Increased motivation and better understanding of the career potential for certain skills can inspire users to take other courses to build those marketable skills. 	Features Learning Dashboard: It provides users an <u>overview</u> of metrics and data about the courses they are taking. It shows them how far in their learning they have come, how much time they have invested, and encourages them to continue learning. <u>Top Skills</u> groups together metrics related to marketable, career-building skills the user is developing based on their courses. The all-new <u>Coursera Percentile</u> metric: gamifies learning on these important skills. Shareable User Profiles: Coursera users gain a robust & customizable user profile that they can use to demonstrate/articulate the skills learned from their completed courses. Documents -- Resume & Portfolio Builder: The Resume Builder allows users to create resumes. The Portfolio Builder allows users to add projects & assignments from their Coursera courses onto portfolios shareable with recruiters or anyone they want to impress. 	Metrics We use the Objective Key Results framework to measure successful outcomes. We want to achieve the following goals: <u>Retention of learners.</u> This is measured through the change in the completion rate of courses (which is currently at 5%) <u>Improved employability of Coursera learners.</u> This is measured through user surveys as they navigate across the platform. <u>User Engagement with Features.</u> This is measured through the number of resumes and portfolios made and the time spent editing user profiles. 
Evangelism Current Signature Track users would be notified of the new features via email and by pop-up the first time they open their profile. The new features would be marketed alongside courses in the same way the Signature Track is. 	Visual Identity Coursera User Profile  	Go to Market Notify existing users of upcoming new features including privacy controls related to our public user profile feature. Gather benchmark data for OKRs. Then, introduce & launch features for Signature Track users. Once features are out there, begin collecting survey data to measure OKR Metrics. 	Key Resources Existing Platform - Coursera hosts simple user profiles with users' completed courses. Credibility - Companies trust Coursera's certifications. Many have partnered on building out courses, and thousands use Coursera for Enterprise 	Risks Allowing profiles to be public poses privacy and security concerns. By allowing users to toggle what is public/private, users are in control. By default, all profiles will be private until users agree to notifications. Users are also in control of how & where their URL is shared. 

Objective-Key Results

We used the Objective Key Results framework.

We want to ensure:

- Objective: Increase retention of learners.
Key Result: We'll measure that through an increase in the completion rate of courses (Currently at 5% [5])
- Objective: We also want to improve the employability of our learners.
Key Result: We measure that through user surveys by asking learners how many of them found the Add to Resume/Portfolio & shareable user profile feature helpful to advance their careers.
- Objective: Improved Engagement of users with our features
Key Result: Measured through an increase in the number of resumes and portfolios made and the time spent editing user profiles.

Launch Strategy and Long Term Improvements

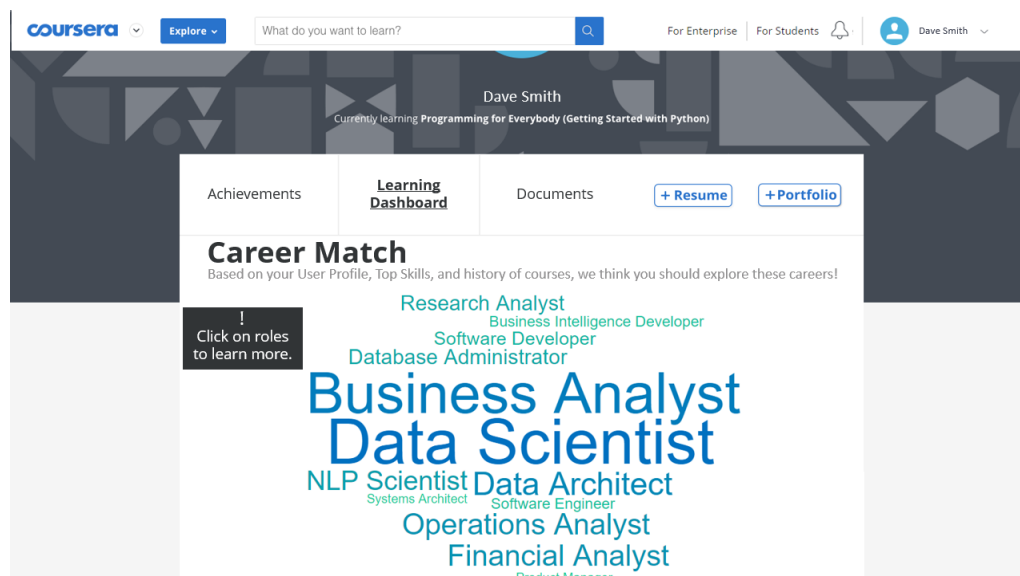
Roll Out Strategy: Product Roll Out Strategy

1. We want to notify existing users of upcoming new features including privacy controls related to our public user profile feature
2. Once the users are notified, we plan on introducing our features to the Signature Track Coursera users
3. Once our features are out there, we will begin collecting survey data in sync with how we want to measure our OKRs to help us evaluate for future updates to our features.

Future Vision for Product: What to Look Out For

For our Long Term Improvements, we'd like to expand upon the initiatives and features we've set out for our proposal:

1. Once the initial features have been fully integrated into the ecosystem, we'd like to expand the initiatives of expanding the user's career portfolio with a feature called Career Match.
 - Career Match: Highlight career paths for users based on the Top Skills on their Learning Dashboard. Based on the top skills, history of courses taken & the user profile details, career match recommends roles that one could target.
 - An example utilizing our Persona: Dave is heavy on Python & Machine Learning-related skills. He is also doing his bachelor's in Data Science. So, our feature recommends him the following jobs which Dave hadn't thought about yet.
2. Through the introduction of Career Match, we'd like to expand upon this initiative by working with a job listing partner such as Indeed to showcase tailored, specific job opportunities for Coursera's users.



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Format: [Citation Number] Link

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[20]<https://www.usnews.com/education/coursera-overview>

[21]<https://about.coursera.org/>

[22]<https://blog.coursera.org/a-milestone-for-signature-track-certificates-for/>

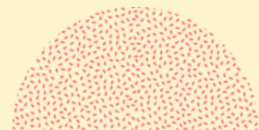
[23]<https://www.businessinsider.com/what-is-linkedin-learning>



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Appendix

Appendix 1: Survey and Responses

Research Insight from Survey:

*MOOC = Massive Open Online Courses (Coursera, edX, etc.)

Total of 23 Responses as of 12/09/2020

Demographic Breakdown:

- Roughly 45% Currently pursuing a bachelor's
- Roughly 40% Completed bachelor's
- Roughly 15% Completing master's or higher

Insight:

- Roughly 90% of respondents have used a MOOC
- Expected gains from MOOCs
 - Career-related (skill development, transferable skills)
 - Educational related (new skills, etc.)
- Biggest challenges faced with MOOCs
 - Motivation, discipline, accountability of learning time (12/21 responses)
 - No end goal in sight
- Prioritizing MOOC work (scale of 1-10):
 - 1 being: It's there if I need it
 - 10 being: I prioritize it as much as school work
 - 12 participants out of 23 total, opted for less than 6.
- What can MOOCs do to keep participants motivated?
 - Way to incentivize or gamify the system to keep students motivated
 - Increase accountability through by setting rewards or end goal

Responses:

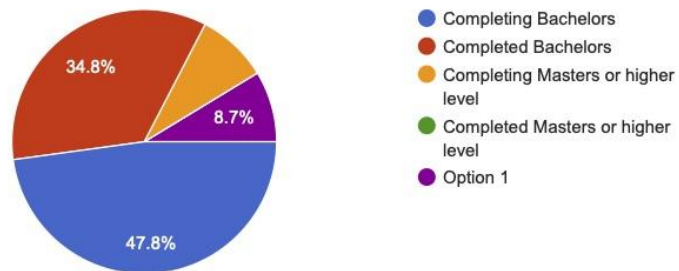
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Coursera User Survey

25 responses

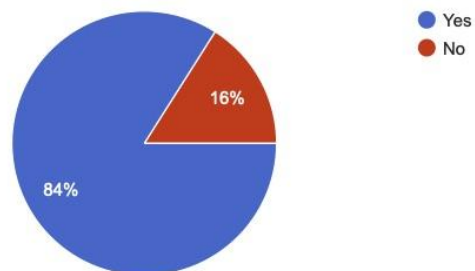
What type of degree are you enrolled in or have completed?

23 responses



Do you use e-learning platforms (examples: Coursera, Udemy, edX, or of similar ilk)?

25 responses



When you use e-learning platforms what do you expect to gain out of it (career-related, educational skillset, etc.)?

25 responses

Career-related goals. Job. etc

Supplemental learning for classes, hobbies

The skills to apply to my career

I expect to be able to access assignments and files from my professors to go over lectures and learn new material.

Usually I use it to gain skills that are either not taught in school, or needed for my job. The goal is to apply these skills in professional setting.

Career-related

Structured programs that I can listen too and skip through if needed

Educational skillset

What are the biggest challenges that you face when taking an online course through an e-learning platform?

25 responses

motivation... I wish i got an immediate benefit. Lose track of end goal (getting a job)

Motivation & enough "consequences" to push through to the end of the course

Asking questions or extra help

I find that not all professors are good at organization and keeping track of their assignments.

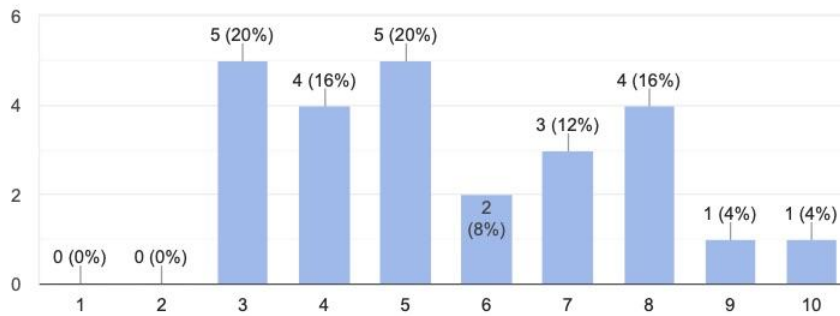
Sometimes courses are too long and hard to commit to. Accountability is the biggest challenge when taking an online course. Short courses make it easier to get the needed knowledge without having to commit for many hours. For this reason, I prefer youtube or linkedin learning.

Lack of interaction with instructor/interpersonal engagement

Not exactly what I need and time consuming to find what I need

On a scale of 1-10 how much do you prioritize the material you learn from e-learning platforms?

25 responses



What can e-learning platforms do better to keep individuals motivated to complete the course?

25 responses

Help me get a job...

Having human interactions (eg. being able to ask TAs questions or having a community of people learning the same content)

Coursera

I think reminders would help students stay on track with their assignments.

Short courses with no strings attached to quickly learn what's needed. Ability to earn a certificate that can be added to LinkedIn

I think if there were more ways for individuals to connect with an instructor figure or a forum for fellow learners to share ideas and questions, it would be helpful.

LinkedIn learning

More certification programs

Appendix 1.1 Survey:

12/9/2020

Coursera User Survey

Coursera User Survey

Please answer to the best of your abilities.

*** Required**

1. Email address *

2. What type of degree are you enrolled in or have completed? *

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Completing Bachelors
☐ Completed Bachelors
☐ Completing Masters or higher level
☐ Completed Masters or higher level

3. Do you use e-learning platforms (examples: Coursera, Udemy, edX, or of similar ilk)? *

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Yes
☐ No

4. When you use e-learning platforms what do you expect to gain out of it (career-related, educational skillset, etc.)? *

5. What are the biggest challenges that you face when taking an online course through an e-learning platform? *

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12/9/2020

Coursera User Survey

6. On a scale of 1-10 how much do you prioritize the material you learn from e-learning platforms? *

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	
It's there if I need it	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	I prioritize it as much as school work

7. What can e-learning platforms do better to keep individuals motivated to complete the course? *

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Google Forms

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